



Sources

This section incorporates information from earlier editions of **Changeling: The Dreaming** and its sourcebooks, including **The Book of Lost Houses: The Second Coming**, **Fools Luck: The Way of the Commoner**, **Immortal Eyes: Court of All Kings**, **Immortal Eyes: Shadows on the Hill**, **Immortal Eyes: The Toybox**, **Isle of the Mighty**, **Kingdom of Willows**, **Noblesse Oblige: Book of Houses**, **Pour Amour et Liberte: Book of Houses 2**, and **War in Concordia**. Some of the material is new to this edition. While there exists room for customization in which to fit your Changeling story, you can find many stories already waiting to unfold in the material that follows as well as in the books listed above.



While sidhe rule most households, a few are overseen by ennobled commoners. These are usually just as loyal — if not more so — to the social structures that elevated them as any sidhe-run house.

Motleys

Groups of commoners form motleys rather than households. Many commoner motleys live outside the feudal paradigm, and some actively oppose the nobles' rule. Offering an alternative to a ruling lord who controls everything about his household, motleys often have an elected leader or switch off so all have a say so in what they do.

First formed in the Interregnum after the sidhe vanished, commoners formed groups for protection. To fit in as part of the mundane world they became traveling circuses, freak shows, or other transient groups. This helped to solidify their independence. When some traveled to the New World, their presence helped spark dreams of rebellion from European control.

Most motleys do establish themselves in freeholds where they work to maintain and protect them from enemies and greedy sidhe alike. Motley freeholds are called *mews*. Some retain some of their nomadic beginnings by taking up residence for a while, then moving on to another — usually by being forcibly evicted.

Relationships vary between motleys and their local nobility. Nobles often consider motleys little more than rowdy gangs and thieves. Some nobles may try to gain control of the motleys in their areas and use them as catspaws or pawns.

Few motleys have any real political power or standing among the noble courts. Still, they stand as the commoners and serve to act as a check on noble power. Further, they provide visible proof, simply by existing, that the commoners do not need nobles to thrive and prosper. For this, some conservatives feel motleys are dangerous; perhaps they are, as their influence among commoners grows daily.

Liege & Vassal

The Seelie Court (and even much of the Unseelie) follows a medieval or feudal state akin to 14th century Europe, the idea of a hierarchy that determines every changeling's place in the community. Those of higher rank are respected by those of lower rank and are also expected to meet their obligations to the less fortunate.

Within the feudal structure, almost every noble owes fealty to a more highly-placed noble. The higher noble is called a liege, the lower one a vassal to that liege. Commoners fall outside this strict hierarchy, and real traditionalists regard them as peasants. In those cases, the nobles consider all commoners to be their subjects.

Many nobles see their main business to be that of gaining — or retaining — power. Others take the bonds between liege and vassal to be the most important duty they fulfill. They see the sacred oaths between liege and vassals as the outward manifestation of the continuity and stability that allows changelings to harvest and protect the Glamour that is the lifeblood of all fae.

Alliances may shift between the nobles and circumstances may change, but all try to expand their holdings and rise higher up the social ladder. Vassals are expected to work on behalf of their liege. In return, a noble liege has duties she owes her vas-



Modern Feudalism

It might seem strange, to a modern reader, that changelings — most of whom were raised human and have the full context of the Autumn world behind them before the Chrysalis — might accept a notion as backwards and outdated as feudalism once they discover their true, Glamorous nature. In truth, changelings rarely have a problem understanding it (accepting is another matter), and the reason is that many of them live with something akin to it already.

In the United States alone, wages haven't meaningfully increased in decades. Some fae scholars trace this trend of the ultra-wealthy consolidating their fortunes to the influence of the returned sidhe. They claim that the dreams of the nation were slowly moving towards true equality when the "nobles" returned, but with that extra burst of *noblesse oblige* that the Shining Host bestowed, the nation is seeing a new feudalism emerge, in which the masses are bound in servitude not by martial force, but by debt, lack of employment options, and cultural norms.

Commoner fae wonder what exactly would have to happen for the pendulum to swing back towards equality, now that their "masters" are actively holding it back. They notice, though, that many mundane people wonder much the same thing as they look to the politicians who grow rich making laws to benefit those even richer. Something has to give.